Concept Note: A Local Pilot for Transparent Common-Resource Allocation

Version: 0.1 draft Purpose: academic review and possible research collaboration Scope: voluntary local pilot; not a proposal for immediate national reform

1. Summary

This concept note proposes a small, voluntary and reversible pilot combining several mechanisms that have been tested separately in China and elsewhere: common or public ownership of selected productive assets, unconditional basic services, a resident social dividend, transparent cost information, voluntary project funding, strategic reserves and independent audit.

The proposal does not claim that these mechanisms are new individually. The research question is whether their combination can improve access to basic goods, productive investment and resilience while keeping decision-making visible and limiting rent extraction.

2. Research question

Can a bounded community coordinate production and allocation without either a central authority assigning every output target or private owners receiving a permanent claim on common productive assets?

3. Proposed institutional package

• Basic provision. A defined basket of essential food, housing, healthcare

and education is provided as a right of residence, subject to transparent capacity limits during the pilot.

• Social dividend. Residents receive an equal periodic share of the

pilot's distributable common product. The dividend does not confer ownership of land, factories or infrastructure.

• Cost information. Published prices show physical cost, capacity,

scarcity and relevant external damage rather than private profit.

• Project funding. Residents may direct part of their discretionary share

to proposals. Funding is released in stages and can be stopped when evidence changes.

• Reserves. The community sets reserve targets for food, medicine, energy

and other critical inputs before a crisis occurs.

• Governance. Executives have limited mandates, are replaceable, and are

subject to parallel audit and public reporting.

4. Pilot boundary

The pilot should begin with one locality, cooperative network or specially authorized development area. It should have:

- a defined resident population;
- a separable budget and asset register;
- legal authority for the selected services and assets;
- a conventional external economy for trade and comparison;
- an independent evaluation team;
- an accessible exit route for residents and participating organizations.

The pilot should not attempt to replace the national economy. Its purpose is to test a limited institutional interface and identify failure modes early.

5. Evaluation

The study should pre-register outcomes before implementation. Candidate measures include access to essential goods, household security, working time, productive output, project completion, reserve reliability, inequality, resident participation, trust, administrative cost and ecological impact.

Results should be compared with matched localities or with the locality's own pre-pilot baseline. A negative result is useful if it identifies which mechanism failed and under what conditions.

6. What this proposal is not

- not a request to adopt a complete ideology;
- not a claim that China has no relevant experience;
- not a plan to remove all markets or professional administration;
- not a promise that transparency eliminates political conflict;
- not a request for implementation before legal, ethical and economic review.

7. Requested collaboration

Researchers are invited to challenge the model, identify Chinese precedents, redesign the pilot boundary, specify legal constraints, propose control groups and estimate whether the package is testable at all.

The desired first outcome is a research critique, not an endorsement.

8. Technical architecture

The model's high-level logic is set out in the model framework. The technical layer is a subsequent, separate document: technical architecture. It covers the physical resource register, electronic voting, the AI assistant, audit, privacy, offline operation and a limited emergency mandate.